

C_SILVERSTEIN_RESUME_2025

Connor Silverstein

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Professional Objective

Chemistry, B.S. candidate with strong foundation in cross-disciplinary coursework, leadership roles, and hands-on research experience in wet chemistry (catalysis, CVD, synthesis, analysis, characterization) and chemical education, and programming research. Seeking internship opportunities with semiconductor design and manufacturing and biotechnology companies.

Education

San Diego State University (San Diego, CA)

Aug. 2021 - May 2026

- Chemistry, B.S., ACS Certification; Chinese Minor. GPA: 3.75.
- Relevant coursework: Chemistry suite, physics suite, calculus.
- Affiliation with SDSU Rocket Project, Taiwanese Student Association, QuantClub (statistics).

National Taiwan University (Taipei, Taiwan)

Aug. 2023 - Jun. 2024

- Study abroad with CSUIP, Dept. of Chemistry. GPA: 3.92.
- Relevant coursework: Adv. General Chinese, Petroleum Geochemistry, Chemistry of Coral Reefs, Chinese Bronze Age Archaeology
- Affiliation with ChongDe Student Volunteer Club, NTU Gymnastics, NTU Ceramics.

Relevant Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Behura Lab at SDSU

Aug. 2025 - CURRENT

- Synthesized in-situ monolayers of MoS₂, hBN on silicon and performed spectroscopic analyses (Raman), PL performed on samples. Trained in cutting-edge optical technology.
- Wrote Python/Matlab script to cut time to analyze wafers by 80%.
- Presented experiment status findings to superiors and team members in weekly group stand-ups.
- Exfoliated hundreds of monolayer samples, assisted in regular lab cleanings and compliance procedures,
- Modified SOPs for our chemical laboratory (furnace, gas mixer, safe handling and storage of chemicals).

Microelectronics and Nanomanufacturing Certificate Program (MNCP)

Jan. 2026 - CURRENT

- In cooperation with UC San Diego, Southwestern College and Penn State.
- Hands-on exposure to techniques common to processing in nanotech fabs.

Komperda Lab at SDSU

Sep. 2024 - CURRENT

- Composed R, Python scripts for LLM APIs to interpret phylogenetic trees from our group's published assessment, publication pending.
- Hosted regular learning sessions with lab members to reinforce R, C++ capabilities.
- Scrutinized >100 assessments for the online CHIRAL database based on item content and size.
- Maintenance of ELM lab notebook. Consistent communication with research partners and PI.

Chemistry Tutor

Aug. 2024 - CURRENT

- Organized regular meetings with local students, facilitated interactive lessons in topics of general and organic chemistry.
- Created teaching aids, including handwritten notes, slide decks and short assessments.
- Documented pupils' improvement.
- Executed marketing campaigns on Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, NextDoor.

Wang Lab at National Taiwan University

Feb. 2024 - Jun. 2024

- Research is development of catalysts to generate self-assembling molecules.
- Synthesis and purification of compounds such as NMI and NDI, realization of further analytical techniques like HPLC.
- Worked in cooperation with faculty and graduate students, oversaw performance of high school students in the laboratory as the first non-Taiwanese research student of Dr. Wang,

Gu Lab

May 2022 - May 2023

- Realized catalyst synthesis for CO₂ reduction before study abroad in Taiwan.
- Familiarized with research norms and literature searches for the first time. Laboratory techniques and writing capabilities honed, ran samples through NMR, Raman, SEM, XRD.
- Cited and reviewed academic literature for the research group.

Supplemental Instruction Facilitator

Aug. 2022 - Dec. 2022

- Facilitated the learning of concepts in general chemistry in a classroom and digital (Zoom) setting on a twice-weekly basis for students of CHEM 200. Utilized various media (presentations, interactive games, discussions) to strengthen students' understanding of class topics.
- Observed trends in student engagement and performance within the sessions and in the general chemistry lecture to report to supervisors, maintained rapport with students and colleagues.

Relevant Skills

- Analytical, proactive approach to problem solving, troubleshooting.
- Effective communicator and public speaker; interactive tutoring abilities.
- Punctual, accurate, organized.
- Fluency in Spanish, Mandarin (HSK 5).
- Office 365, Google workspace/G suite (Matlab, Python, R, C++), computer modeling (Gaussian, Mestrenova), CAD, qualitative and statistical software.
- Team leader and player.
- Laboratory and instrumentation*

*: including dutiful maintenance of laboratory notebook; enforcement of EH&S protocol; synthesis, separation, purification of cell cultures, proteins; PCR, ELISA; chromatography (HPLC, GC), TOFMS, spectroscopy (UV-Vis, IR, Raman, H & C, solid state NMR, ONMR, fluorescence, laser), tensiometry, electrochemical cells, PCB, SEM, STM, TEM, XRD, cyclic voltammetry, flow cytometry.

Awards, Posters & Certifications

- Microelectronics and Nanomanufacturing Certificate Program (MNCP) *Jan. 2026 - Apr. 2026* with UC San Diego, Southwestern College and Pennsylvania State University.
 - Highest score on ACS Physical Chemistry Exam *AY2024-25.*
 - Dean's list recognition.
- Silverstein, C.; Marcroft, T.; Daniel, K.; 2025.07.10, *Comparing the tree-thinking performance of two multimodal conversational artificial intelligences (MMCAI)*; Society for the Advancement of Biology Education Research (SABER); Minneapolis, MN.

Hobbies

- Soap making and crocheting
 - Sourcing and working with caustic (NaOH, KOH) and speciality (fragrances) materials in precise quantities to render a final product for personal use and for patrons and friends.
 - Proper chemical handling, storage, and disposal. Maintenance of a laboratory space.
 - Deliberate handwork and efficiency in creating a final product for selective consumers.
- (Electric) bicycle repair
 - Diagnostic repairs of user-owned transportation equipment with materials sourced from local vendors.

Volunteer Experience

- American Field Service (AFS), San Diego Area Team. (Coordination with USDoS)
 - Orientations and facilitated cultural activities for exchange students to local high schools.
 - Executed marketing campaigns online and with local youth groups.
 - Personally lobbied Congress Reps Scott Peters, Darrell Issa; led discussions with reps to continue funding SPs.
- San Diego Refugee Tutoring (SDRT)
 - Twice weekly tutored students of parents recently settled in San Diego at Ibarra Elementary School in interest of academic and personal development.
 - Active participation with special event planning and execution.